

mother's, you're going to have to take this stuff more seriously. Starting now.

EIGHT DATES THAT WON'T BREAK THE BANK

Dating doesn't have to cost a fortune. Sometimes the best bonding experiences are the ones that cost the least. Here are eight ideas for fun, memorable dates that won't hurt the wallet.

1. **Take a stroll.** It's no coincidence that both walking and dancing played a key role in the early days of George and Georgette's courtship. Moving your body makes you feel good. It's also *free*. When my wife, Linda, and I started dating, we walked everywhere. Exercise boosts your energy level, delivering oxygen and nutrients to your heart, lungs and brain. It also gives couples a chance to talk. Why not take a day hike or bike around town? Linda and I used to rent bicycles to get from A to B—many big cities have wonderful bike paths. We also went skating in the winter. Find a place where you can rent a cheap pair of skates and hit the ice. Bonus: you're getting a jump start on a healthy relationship. Literally.
2. **Explore a museum or an art gallery.** Taking your date to a museum is a great way to stimulate conversation. And I'm not talking about dull dinosaurs; I'm talking about cool modern exhibits on art and music. Last winter, there was a Patti Smith exhibit at the Royal Ontario Museum in Toronto. Linda and I loved it. We'll definitely be checking out the David Bowie exhibit at the Art Gallery of Ontario, too. If you're a member, admission is often free for you and a guest. If you're not, scan an events calendar. Most cities offer free admission